

EARNED,
NOT GRANTED.

We don't teach AI. We make engineers who **ship**.

An AI-native product engineering apprenticeship for India.

Traditional curriculum cannot keep pace with AI-native engineering workflows.

WHERE CURRICULUM ENDS

- Theoretical foundations are strong
- Limited time for shipping practice
- Production deployment rarely taught
- AI-assisted tools change every quarter
- AI debugging is a different discipline
- Startup workflows are hard to simulate in-class

WHAT STARTUPS NEED

- AI-assisted development fluency
- Shipping velocity over algorithm depth
- Product and architecture judgment
- Evaluation discipline for AI features
- Async collaboration habits
- Debug AI hallucination, not just human bugs

Five reasons tier-2 colleges sign on.

Stagnant placements. Tier-1 student exits. NAAC pressure. No internal AI capacity. Admissions on autopilot.

- | | | |
|-----------|-----------------------------------|---|
| 01 | Placement statistics | Stagnant or declining numbers, with student exits to tier-1 alternatives. |
| 02 | Industry partnerships | AICTE and NAAC rankings increasingly weight industry tie-ups. |
| 03 | AI branding gap | "AI" is now table stakes, but no credible AI programme to point to. |
| 04 | Faculty bandwidth | No internal capacity to build or run an AI-native curriculum. |
| 05 | Admissions differentiation | Private colleges compete on marketing in every admission cycle. |

A 13-week apprenticeship. Not a course.

**Earned,
not granted.**

Built for engineering students. Integrated with tier-2 engineering colleges.
Designed around shipping, not sitting through slides.

13

WEEKS

Aligned to intensive windows

100

STUDENTS PER COHORT

In pods of 8-12, one mentor each

0

LECTURES

Students ship from week one

A week inside BuildAI looks like a week inside an AI startup.

MON	Sprint Kickoff	Week plan posted async. Students commit work in Linear.
TUE — THU	Build Days	AI-assisted implementation. PRs opened. Peer code reviews.
FRI	Demo Day	Async Loom demo from every student. Public archive.
SAT	Live Mentor Session	90-min architecture review, debugging, Q&A.
SUN	Peer Review	Cross-pod portfolio reviews. Reading group reflections.

A Wednesday in Week 6 of a BuildAI cohort.

Not a class schedule. The actual rhythm of a working AI startup, lived by a 3rd-year engineering student.

09:00 AM

Review PR comments

Mentor left feedback overnight on yesterday's PR. Student replies, pushes a fix, requests re-review.

10:30 AM

Open GitHub issue

Linear ticket for new feature. Student writes a 3-sentence design note before touching code.

12:00 PM

Build with Cursor

AI-assisted implementation. Half the code is generated; the student reviews and refactors every line.

03:00 PM

Debugging session

Hallucinated API response in production. Student traces logs, writes a regression eval, ships fix in 45 min.

05:00 PM

Review peer's PR

Cross-pod review. Student leaves 4 substantive comments on another student's submission.

07:00 PM

Record Loom demo

3-minute walkthrough of what shipped today. Posted to public Demo Day archive.

Six modules, organised around capabilities startups hire for.

M0

WEEK 1

AI-Native OS

Ship one working app by end of week 1.

M1

WEEKS 2 - 4

Product Engineering

Two deployed apps with auth and database.

M2

WEEKS 5 - 7

AI Product Patterns

One real AI-powered product.

M3

WEEK 8

Eval & Reliability

Eval suite that catches regressions.

M4

WEEKS 9 - 10

Shipping in a Startup

Team sprint with PR-reviewed code.

M5

WEEKS 11 - 13

Capstone

Real product, real users.

Seven dimensions. Two reviewers. External industry validation.

01	Shipping velocity	SCORED 1 – 5
02	Engineering judgment	SCORED 1 – 5
03	Product thinking	SCORED 1 – 5
04	AI fluency	SCORED 1 – 5
05	Collaboration	SCORED 1 – 5
06	Debugging	SCORED 1 – 5
07	Communication	SCORED 1 – 5

EXTERNAL VALIDATION

At Week 13, working engineers from real AI-first startups review top portfolios independently.

Their feedback enters the final score — and they become the hiring pipeline.

Three tiers. Earned, not granted.

Only ~30% of every cohort earns Apprentice Certified or above. Scarcity is what creates startup trust.

~ **70%**

PARTICIPATED

Finished the programme, completed all assignments.

~ **20%**

APPRENTICE CERTIFIED

All 7 rubric dimensions scored 3 or higher.

~ **10%**

DISTINCTION

Top performers, externally validated, featured in BuildAI's startup review network.

What every Apprentice Certified graduate walks away with.

5+

Deployed products in public portfolio

3+

Live URLs with working demos

1

Capstone reviewed by AI startup engineer

13

Weeks of PR-reviewed real code

8+

Loom architecture walkthroughs

1

Eval suite demonstrating reliability

What your institution gets when you partner with BuildAI.

01

Credible AI programme

An AI-native offering your admissions team can point to immediately.

02

Industry partnership

Documented industry tie-up for NAAC, AICTE, and placement reports.

03

Student outcomes

Measurable GitHub portfolios. Real deployed products. Marketing assets you own.

04

Administrative margin

₹5,000–₹7,000 per enrolled student. Yours to keep.

05

Zero faculty burden

BuildAI runs the entire programme. Your faculty focuses on core curriculum.

06

Hiring network access

Top graduates introduced to BuildAI's startup review network — a long-term pipeline.

Simple economics. College keeps administrative margin.

STUDENT FEE

**₹20K –
₹25K**

What students pay for the 13-week apprenticeship.

COLLEGE MARGIN

₹5K – ₹7K

Per enrolled student. Administrative + facilitation margin.

BUILD AI FEE

**₹15K –
₹18K**

Per enrolled student. Covers mentors, tools, ops, evaluation.

Per-cohort revenue for college $(100 \times ₹6,000) = ₹6 \text{ lakh}$

Two cohorts per year (summer + winter) **= ₹12 lakh annual margin to your institution**

Why BuildAI is not Newton School, upGrad, or Internshala.

	BuildAI	Newton School	upGrad	Internshala
Format	Apprenticeship	Embedded school	Video courses	Self-paced
AI-native?	Built-in	Bolted on	Generic literacy	Basic prompts
Evaluation	7-dim + external review	Internal grading	Course completion	Auto certificate
Output	Public portfolio	Class projects	Certificate	Certificate
Pass rate	~70% (gated)	~90%+	~95%+	~95%+
Price	₹20-25K	₹3-5L	₹15-40K	₹2-5K

AI is reshaping how software is built. India can either supply this workforce — or be supplied by it.

WHAT I'VE SEEN

Working at an AI-native company in the US, I see what AI-first startups actually hire for. The gap between that profile and what Indian colleges produce is structural, not cosmetic. It is also closeable in 13 weeks if the apprenticeship is rigorous.

WHY ME

IIT Bombay gave me the engineering foundation. Cornell Johnson sharpened the operating lens. Founding an AI-native company taught me what shipping actually feels like. The combination is what's needed to build a credible apprenticeship.

WHY NOW

AI-assisted engineering is no longer a 5-year horizon. It is the workflow. The colleges that integrate it over the next 18 months will define their placement decade. The ones that wait will spend five years catching up.

Built by a founder who has lived this gap.



Sharad Agrawal

Founder, BuildAI

IIT Bombay Masters, 2018

Cornell Johnson MBA, 2024

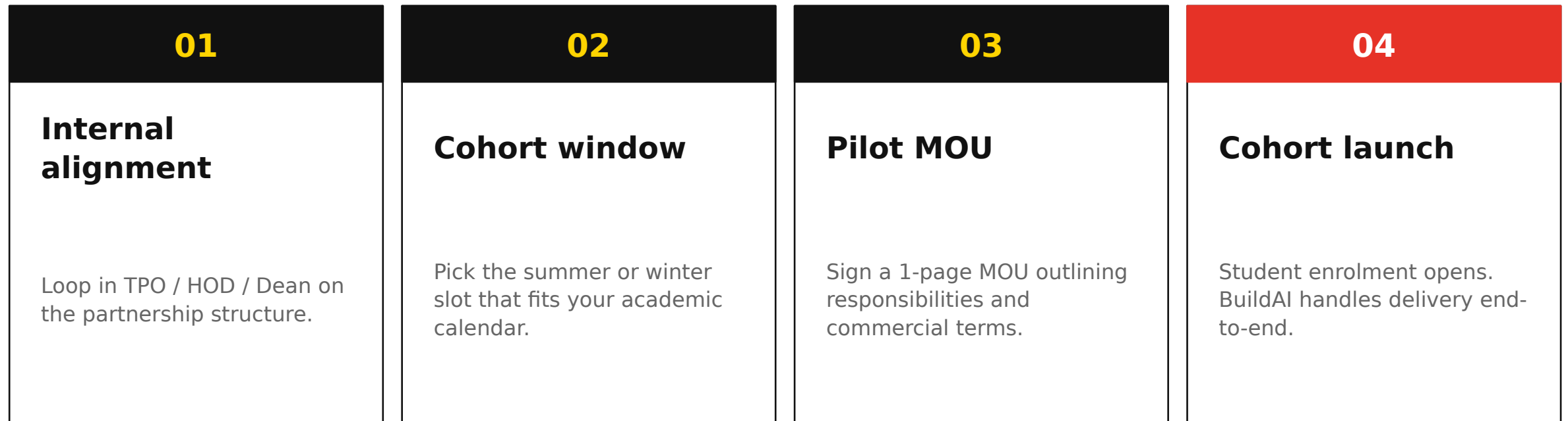
Currently Founder of an AI-native company in the US

Based in US · India ops led by co-founder
(recruitment in progress)

"The single most important hire of the next 18 months is the India co-founder."

— INTERNAL STRATEGY DOC

Pilot partnership process.



Let's run a pilot together.

Even a 30-student first cohort produces public proof your institution can show.

SHARAD AGRAWAL

Founder, BuildAI

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IIT Bombay '18 · Cornell MBA '24